menler

CLAUDE-FIRST FELLOWSHIP · WEEK 4

INSTRUCTIONS

My automated AI system

Build an AI system that runs on its own — a workflow where Claude is the brain, real tools are the hands, and the whole thing keeps working while you sleep.

Week 4 · Claude · N8N / Make · MCP tools · Voice (VAPI / ElevenLabs)

Your turning point in the AI era.

W4

My automated AI system

Milestone Project 3 · The brief

WHAT YOU'LL BUILD

A system that takes an **input** — a message, a form, or a spoken question — lets **Claude decide** what to do, uses **real tools** to act, and delivers a **result**, all without you pressing a button each time. You are not building a chatbot; you are building something that runs itself.

- An **automation flow** (N8N or Make) as the skeleton that moves data from step to step.
- **Claude as the intelligence** — it reads the input, decides, and writes the output.
- At least **three connected MCP tools** so the system can act in the real world.
- A **Routine** that chains the steps into one repeatable job.
- A **voice layer** (VAPI or ElevenLabs) so the system can speak or listen.

WHY IT MATTERS

Anyone can prompt Claude once. The leap this week is making Claude work **without you in the loop** — the difference between a tool you operate and a system that operates for you. That is the skill employers and clients actually pay for.

WHERE IT RUNS

N8N or Make for the flow, Claude for the thinking, your MCP tools (Notion, Slack, Airtable, Gmail) for the actions, and a voice provider on top.

WHEN TO BUILD & USE IT

Build it across the week; run it on a **Schedule** (a daily brief, a weekly digest) or on a **trigger** (a new form entry, an inbound call).

W4 My automated AI system

How to approach it

THE METHOD

This is the path, not the answer. Each step is a decision for you to make — the Solution book shows *one* way to make them.

1. **Pick one system to build.** Student Assistant, Startup Intake, Content Pipeline, or your own. Choose the one you would actually use.
2. **Map the flow on paper first.** Four boxes: input → decide → act → deliver. If you cannot draw it, you cannot build it.
3. **Write the Claude step as a strict instruction.** Tell it exactly what to read, what to decide, and what shape to return (usually JSON).
4. **Connect the tools it needs** — the three MCP connectors the "act" box depends on.
5. **Wire it together in N8N or Make**, then add the voice layer last, once the text path already works.
6. **Put it on a Schedule and test it end to end** with a real input, then a messy one.

REQUIREMENTS

- [ ] A working flow that runs without manual steps.
- [ ] Claude making at least one real decision.
- [ ] Three or more MCP tools connected.
- [ ] A voice layer that speaks or listens.

HAND IN

A short **Loom or screen recording** of the system running end to end, plus the **Claude step instruction** you wrote and a one-paragraph note on what it automates and who it is for.

A LITTLE HINT

Build the **text path first** and get it fully working — input to result — before you add voice. Voice is a microphone and a speaker bolted onto a system that already works; it is never the thing that makes it work.